

# Imposter Who? — Build Specification

**For:** Claude Code **Goal:** Build a free, offline, mobile-first party game as an installable web app (PWA). No backend, no accounts, no payments, works with no internet after first load.

A working greyscale **flow prototype already exists** ( `Imposter_Mockup.html` ). Use it as the functional reference for game logic and flow. This build productionises it: real visual design, offline/installable (PWA), expanded word bank, polish. Keep all rules below exactly.

## 1. Tech requirements

- **Single-page web app**, mobile-first, portrait. Plain HTML/CSS/JS is acceptable and preferred for guaranteed offline simplicity; React + Vite is fine if you prefer a build step.
- **Installable PWA**: add a `manifest.json` and a service worker that caches all assets so the game runs fully offline and can be saved to a phone home screen.
- **No backend, no network calls at runtime**. All data (word bank, logic) ships inside the app.
- **No localStorage dependency for core play**. Use it only to remember player names between games (optional enhancement); the game must work if storage is unavailable.
- **Sound**: synthesised in-app via the Web Audio API (no audio files). Built so real audio clips can be swapped in later.
- **Quality floor**: responsive on small phones, visible focus states, respects `prefers-reduced-motion`, large tap targets.

## 2. The game in one line

Everyone gets the same secret word — except the **imposters**, who get a vague clue that describes it. Players give one-word clues out loud; the room debates and votes people out. If the word is *window*, an imposter might see *view*.

## 3. Two modes

### Classic

- No teams. One shared word; imposters get clues.
- Player chooses **how many imposters** (min 1; cap so innocents always outnumber imposters:  $\text{max} = \text{floor}((\text{players} - 1) / 2)$ ).
- **Players win** when every imposter is voted out.
- **Imposters win** if the number of alive imposters becomes **equal to or greater than** the number of alive innocents.

### Team

- Players split into **N teams** chosen by the user. **One imposter hidden per team** (so N imposters total).
- **Hidden allegiances**: a player knows their own team number but **not who else is on their team**. This is essential — never show teammates.
- Because teams are hidden, **all innocents share one word** (different words per team would leak team membership through clue clusters).
- **Win**: the **last team with an uncaught imposter wins**. Auto-declared.

## 4. Setup flow

1. **Home screen**: choose mode (Classic / Team), choose category (or **Random**), sound on/off toggle.
2. **Setup screen**:
3. Add player names — **any number**. Names can be **deleted** as they're added. Optionally remember names between games.
4. **Classic**: input for number of imposters (validated, see caps above).
5. **Team**: input for number of teams. **Each team must have at least 3 members**. Reject/warn if  $\text{floor}(\text{players} / \text{teams}) < 3$ , or if too few players.
6. On start, the app:
7. Shuffles players. Team mode: distribute as evenly as possible across teams (uneven is fine, e.g. 14 into 4 → 4-4-3-3).
8. Assigns imposters (one per team / N in classic).
9. Picks the secret word and a **different clue word for each imposter** (so imposters can't recognise each other).

## 5. Card deal (pass-the-phone)

- Show one player at a time: a card displaying their **name**, and a prompt "Pass the phone to **[name]**".
- **Press and hold** the card to reveal: the player's **secret word**, or if they're an imposter, their **clue word** and (team mode) their **team number**. Releasing hides it instantly back to the name.
- Show the current **round number** and **how many rounds since the word last changed**.
- A "Next player" button advances; the last card's button reads "Everyone's seen — start round".

## 6. Round loop

1. Players give one-word clues out loud and debate (off-app).
2. **Vote screen**: list all alive players as tappable items. Round number shown. Tapping a name opens a **confirm step** ("Vote out [name]?") to prevent mistakes.

- 3. On confirm → **Reveal screen: a drumroll** (sound + animation) for ~1.5s, then the verdict and nothing else:
- 4. Team mode: **"Team X lost their imposter"** or **"Team X lost an innocent"**.
- 5. Classic: **"Imposter caught!"** or **"Innocent — wrong vote"**.
- 6. Apply consequences (section 7), check win, continue.
- 7. **Every 2 rounds**, a **new word** is introduced to the surviving players (re-deal: pass the phone around again to reveal it). The **same players stay imposters all game** — only the word and clues change.

## 7. Rules that matter

| Rule                    | Behaviour                                                                                        |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Wrong vote hurts        | Voting out an innocent eliminates them anyway (both modes).                                      |
| Caught imposter (Team)  | That team can no longer win, but its remaining members <b>stay in and keep playing/voting</b> .  |
| New word every 2 rounds | Same imposters throughout; only the word + each imposter's clue change.                          |
| Tie votes               | Resolved by rock-paper-scissors in real life; the app just waits for the final name.             |
| Quit                    | A quit (x) button on every in-game screen → confirm ("Quit to home? This game will end") → home. |

## 8. Win conditions (summary)

- **Team:** when only one team still has an uncaught imposter, that team wins. Then show a **full reveal**: every player grouped by team, with imposters marked.
- **Classic — players:** all imposters voted out.
- **Classic — imposters:** alive imposters ≥ alive innocents.
- On win: play a **fanfare**, show the result and full reveal, and offer **Play again** with the choice to **reuse the same names** or **enter new names**.

## 9. Sound (synthesised, mutable)

Four cues, all generated via Web Audio (no files), respecting the mute toggle (default on):

- **Drumroll** — before every elimination verdict.
- **Imposter caught** — sharp, dramatic sting.
- **Innocent lost** — softer, deflating tone.
- **Winner** — short fanfare.

Build these behind a small sound module so recorded clips can replace the synth versions later without touching game logic.

## 10. Screens checklist

1. Home (mode, category, sound)
2. Setup (names, counts, validation)
3. Card deal (hold-to-reveal, pass-the-phone)
4. Vote (player list + confirm)
5. Reveal (drumroll → verdict)
6. Winner (result + full reveal + play again)
7. Modals: vote confirm, quit confirm.

## 11. Word bank

Ships inside the app. Structure: each category maps to a list of entries; each entry is a secret **word** plus a pool of vague **clue** words (one assigned to each imposter, all different). Target **~20 entries per category** for the real build — expand the starter set below. Clues must describe the word vaguely and fairly (never name it, never be so specific they give it away).

Current categories: **Everyday Objects, Food & Drinks, Animals, Places, Singing Artists, Movies, Anime Shows, Cartoons**, plus a **Random** option that draws across all.

Starter data (expand each to ~20):

```
{
  "Everyday Objects": [
    {"word": "Window", "clues": ["view", "glass", "frame", "light"]},
    {"word": "Umbrella", "clues": ["rain", "cover", "fold", "shade"]},
    {"word": "Mirror", "clues": ["reflection", "glass", "face", "shine"]},
    {"word": "Ladder", "clues": ["climb", "steps", "height", "reach"]}
  ],
  "Food & Drinks": [
    {"word": "Pizza", "clues": ["slice", "cheese", "round", "oven"]},
    {"word": "Coffee", "clues": ["morning", "bitter", "cup", "awake"]},
    {"word": "Banana", "clues": ["yellow", "peel", "curve", "soft"]},
    {"word": "Ice cream", "clues": ["cold", "scoop", "melt", "sweet"]}
  ],
  "Animals": [
    {"word": "Elephant", "clues": ["trunk", "grey", "huge", "memory"]},
    {"word": "Penguin", "clues": ["cold", "waddle", "suit", "ice"]}
  ]
}
```

```
{
  "word": "Shark", "clues": ["teeth", "ocean", "fin", "fear"]},
  {
    "word": "Owl", "clues": ["night", "wise", "silent", "eyes"]}
],
"Places": [
  {
    "word": "Beach", "clues": ["sand", "waves", "sun", "towel"]},
    {
      "word": "Airport", "clues": ["travel", "wait", "gate", "luggage"]},
      {
        "word": "Hospital", "clues": ["white", "quiet", "care", "beds"]},
        {
          "word": "Library", "clues": ["quiet", "books", "study", "shh"]}
],
"Singing Artists": [
  {
    "word": "Beyoncé", "clues": ["pop", "stage", "icon", "powerful"]},
    {
      "word": "Drake", "clues": ["rap", "Toronto", "charts", "mood"]},
      {
        "word": "Rihanna", "clues": ["pop", "island", "brand", "voice"]},
        {
          "word": "Burna Boy", "clues": ["afrobeats", "Nigeria", "energy", "grammy"]},
          {
            "word": "Taylor Swift", "clues": ["pop", "stories", "fans", "eras"]},
            {
              "word": "The Weeknd", "clues": ["night", "falsetto", "moody", "hits"]},
              {
                "word": "Tyla", "clues": ["amapiano", "viral", "dance", "SouthAfrica"]},
                {
                  "word": "Ed Sheeran", "clues": ["acoustic", "ginger", "loop", "ballads"]}
],
"Movies": [
  {
    "word": "Titanic", "clues": ["ship", "romance", "ocean", "tragedy"]},
    {
      "word": "Avatar", "clues": ["blue", "aliens", "jungle", "3D"]},
      {
        "word": "Inception", "clues": ["dreams", "layers", "mind", "spinning"]},
        {
          "word": "Avengers", "clues": ["heroes", "team", "battle", "marvel"]},
          {
            "word": "Jurassic Park", "clues": ["dinosaurs", "island", "science", "chaos"]},
            {
              "word": "Black Panther", "clues": ["wakanda", "king", "vibranium", "hero"]},
              {
                "word": "Joker", "clues": ["clown", "dark", "laugh", "chaos"]},
                {
                  "word": "Spider-Man", "clues": ["web", "spider", "hero", "city"]}
],
"Anime Shows": [
  {
    "word": "Naruto", "clues": ["ninja", "village", "orange", "fox"]},
    {
      "word": "One Piece", "clues": ["pirate", "ocean", "hat", "treasure"]},
      {
        "word": "Attack on Titan", "clues": ["titans", "walls", "war", "freedom"]},
        {
          "word": "Dragon Ball", "clues": ["fighters", "energy", "saiyan", "power"]},
          {
            "word": "Demon Slayer", "clues": ["demons", "sword", "breathing", "night"]},
            {
              "word": "Death Note", "clues": ["notebook", "detective", "rules", "fate"]},
              {
                "word": "My Hero Academia", "clues": ["heroes", "quirks", "school", "power"]},
                {
                  "word": "Pokémon", "clues": ["creatures", "trainer", "battles", "catch"]}
],
"Cartoons": [
  {
    "word": "SpongeBob", "clues": ["sea", "sponge", "yellow", "fun"]},
    {
      "word": "Tom and Jerry", "clues": ["cat", "mouse", "chase", "silent"]},
      {
        "word": "The Simpsons", "clues": ["yellow", "family", "town", "satire"]},
        {
          "word": "The Lion King", "clues": ["savanna", "cub", "kingdom", "circle"]},
          {
            "word": "The Last Airbender", "clues": ["elements", "bending", "balance", "journey"]},
            {
              "word": "Rick and Morty", "clues": ["portal", "science", "space", "grandpa"]},
              {
                "word": "Ben 10", "clues": ["watch", "aliens", "transform", "hero"]},
                {
                  "word": "Powerpuff Girls", "clues": ["sugar", "spice", "heroines", "city"]}
]
}
```

## 12. Acceptance criteria

- [ ] Runs fully offline after first load; installable to a phone home screen.
- [ ] Both modes playable end to end.
- [ ] Classic asks for imposter count; Team asks for team count; both validate (≥3 per team; imposters < innocents).
- [ ] Hold-to-reveal hides instantly on release; teammates never shown.
- [ ] Vote requires a confirm; verdict shows only the team + role line.
- [ ] New word arrives every 2 rounds to survivors; imposters stay fixed.
- [ ] Wrong votes eliminate innocents; caught imposters' teammates stay in.
- [ ] Correct auto-win for each mode, followed by a full reveal.
- [ ] Drumroll + verdict + winner sounds, with a working mute toggle.
- [ ] Quit-to-home (with confirm) on every in-game screen.
- [ ] Word bank ~20 per category, vague fair clues.

Build reference: the existing [Imposter\\_Mockup.html](#) demonstrates the full flow and logic. Match its behaviour; replace its rough greyscale look with a real, distinctive visual design.